



1942

1944



Simple lines Designer Helen Cookman produced good-quality, ready-to-wear lines and was known for her tailored clothes and tweeds. The simple line of this ensemble is underlined by the use of velvet trim in strategic places.

Smart casual The simple design of this green knit dress is enlivened by the metallic fastening at the collar and the belt. Described as a "sports dress", it would have been regarded as smart casual wear for town and country.

Coordinating separates This 1942 ensemble by Vera Maxwell includes a bloomer playsuit, skirt, waistcoat, and tailored coat, all made from artificially produced fabrics developed by American companies.

Holiday clothes Claire McCardell designed this practical resort wear ensemble for Townley Frocks. The skirt and halter top could be interchanged with shorts and a slip-over blouse. McCardell liked to use practical, easy-care fabrics like "everfast cotton".

FOOTWEAR TRENDS

Before the war Paris not only dictated fashionable silhouettes but was the source of inspiration for accessories. American shoe manufacturer Delman – founder of one of the top footwear brands in the US – opened a design studio in Paris, so that he could keep up with the latest trends in shoes. The designs he brought back to sell in America during the 1930s had the added fashion credibility of being Paris models.

Parisian influence was lost during the war, but made a comeback towards the late 1940s. At this time Italian shoe design also started to gain fashion credence with the production of light, elegant sandals with slimmed-down heels. The two pairs of American shoes illustrated below show the influence of the new European designs, featuring cut-away sections that reveal more of the foot, and higher, slimmer heels than in previous years.



Peep toes

Cutaway sides